



ALEX LEITH

EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR & PRINCIPAL CONSULTANT

Alex Leith has spent fifteen years making geospatial data work for the people who need it most. As founder and Executive Director of Auspacious, he leads a team delivering cloud-native geospatial platforms across the Pacific, Southeast Asia, and beyond — translating complex data into actionable intelligence that drives sustainable development, environmental reporting, and marine spatial planning for some of the world's most climate-exposed communities.

FEATURED PROJECTS

DIGITAL EARTH PACIFIC

PACIFIC COMMUNITY (SPC)

- Lead technical strategy and cloud infrastructure for Digital Earth Pacific, serving 26 Pacific Island Countries and Territories.
- Author and deliver the DEP Technical Roadmap, charting the long term direction for cloud-native Earth observation infrastructure across the Pacific.
- Architect and execute the platform migration from Azure to AWS, reducing operating costs and improving performance for Pacific users.
- Deliver core data products including Satellite Derived Bathymetry and Sentinel-2 cloud-free mosaics, and mentor the DEP technical team.

LAND DEGRADATION NEUTRALITY FOR SIDS

CONSERVATION INTERNATIONAL

- Collaborate with Conservation International and the Pacific Community to deliver high-resolution land cover intelligence for Small Island Developing States.
- Design a 30-metre annual land use and land cover dataset spanning 2000–2024, aligned with UNCCD requirements and SDG 15.3.1 reporting.
- Build an open-science pipeline using Landsat GeoMedian composites, ML classification, and cloud-native publication via Google Earth Engine, Zenodo and Trends.Earth.
- Address a critical monitoring gap for SIDS, where existing global datasets are too coarse to capture fine-grained island land dynamics.

SPATIAL DATA FRAMEWORK FOR COASTAL & OCEAN REPORTING

UNIVERSITY OF NEW SOUTH WALES

- Design a cloud-native spatial data platform for UNSW's Centre for Sustainable Development Reform — datasets, pipelines and reporting tools in one transparent system.
- Build on open-source technologies to minimise vendor lock-in, ensuring UNSW and its partners can operate and extend the system independently.
- Support sustained capability through structured workshops and documentation designed to outlast the project delivery period.

CONTACT

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SKILLS

- Project Management
- Cloud-Native Geospatial Architecture
- Data & Software Engineering
- Capacity Development
- Governance & Leadership
- Stakeholder Engagement & Communication

EDUCATION

- Graduate, Australian Institute of Company Directors (GAICD)
- Certified in Cybersecurity, ISC2
- Graduate of the Tasmanian Leaders Program
- Certified GIS Professional, Asia-Pacific (GISP-AP)
- Bachelor of Surveying & Spatial Information Science (First Class Hons), UTAS

ALEX LEITH

CAREER HISTORY

- **Executive Director**
Auspatious
- **Deputy Director**
IMOS · Australian Ocean
Data Network
- **Assistant Director**
Geoscience Australia
- **Technical Delivery
Manager**
FrontierSI
- **Spatial Information
Analyst**
TasNetworks
- **GIS Administrator**
Glenorchy City Council
- **Spatial Analyst**
Lester Franks

REFEREES

Available upon request

SELECTED ENGAGEMENTS

COASTAL EARTH OBSERVATION APPLICATIONS, SOUTHEAST ASIA

GEOSCIENCE AUSTRALIA

- Work alongside the Marine Resources Initiative to deliver Earth observation expertise, data processing and training to partner agencies across Vietnam, the Philippines and Indonesia.
- Lead practical training workshops equipping regional teams with satellite-derived coastal monitoring tools for marine spatial planning and resource management.
- Support Indonesia's national geospatial agency through in-country workshops in Bogor and follow-on cloud analysis training in Sydney.
- Build lasting in-country capability so partner teams can now independently run national-scale coastal and marine analyses.

DIGITAL EARTH AUSTRALIA & DIGITAL EARTH AFRICA

GEOSCIENCE AUSTRALIA

- Led software development and data engineering teams delivering national and continental-scale Earth observation platforms across two continents.
- Managed petabytes of analysis-ready satellite data across national supercomputing and public cloud environments, establishing scalable infrastructure.
- Drove adoption of open standards and cloud-native approaches now foundational to the global Digital Earth community.
- Directed cross-functional technical teams, balancing architectural leadership with program governance and stakeholder engagement.

AUSTRALIAN OCEAN DATA NETWORK (AODN)

INTEGRATED MARINE OBSERVING SYSTEM

- Directed a team of 25+ professionals delivering Australia's federally funded national marine data capability — collection, curation and open publication of marine observation data.
- Led strategic planning and held executive accountability for cyber security governance across a complex, multi-stakeholder program.
- Managed contracting and delivery of multi-million-dollar programs of work across government and research partners.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Non-Executive Director & Treasurer · Earth Observation Australia
- Steering Council Member · SpatioTemporal Asset Catalog (STAC)
- Co-Chair · Global FOSS4G 2025, Auckland
- Director · Surveying & Spatial Sciences Institute (2012–17)
- Non-Executive Director, Chair & Treasurer · OSGeo Oceania
- Co-Convenor · Advancing Earth Observation Forum 2026
- Non-Executive Director · Geospatial Council of Australia (2024–25)